Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Chord mechanics, muting, and open-chord foundation

8 OPEN CHORDS | 3 POWER CHORDS | 780 ATTACKS

Section VI begins by correcting the largest remaining imbalance in the curriculum: harmony and rhythm-guitar execution. Level 49 teaches eight essential open chords, three open power chords, minimum fretting pressure, unused-string muting, clean release, and changes at whole-, half-, and quarter-note speed.

1. Make one chord clean

Build from the bass side, use the printed fingering, and verify every ringing or muted string before increasing speed.

2. Move without excess motion

Common fingers stay down; guide fingers release and travel close to the strings; unused fingers remain relaxed.

3. Keep the rhythm alive

The chord change belongs inside the beat. A clean but late chord is not yet a successful transition.

Core chord set and attack zones

Chord	Frets low E -> high e	Spelling	Start string
Em	0 2 2 0 0 0	E G B	all 6 strings
E	0 2 2 1 0 0	E G# B	all 6 strings
Am	x 0 2 2 1 0	A C E	A string through high e
A	x 0 2 2 2 0	A C# E	A string through high e
Dm	x x 0 2 3 1	D F A	D string through high e
D	x x 0 2 3 2	D F# A	D string through high e
C	x 3 2 0 1 0	C E G	A string through high e
G	3 2 0 0 0 3	G B D	all 6 strings

Notated attack count

Mechanics labs	72
Open-chord cells	96
Power chords	36
Whole-note changes	64
Half-note changes	64
Quarter-note changes	128
Transition economy	64
Six-string audits	96
Progressions	96
Capstone	64
TOTAL	**780**

Level boundary

This level does not ask for fast eighth- or sixteenth-note strumming. It establishes clean chord formation and changes at whole, half, and quarter notes. Level 50 will expand transition timing and common-finger movement; later levels add barre chords, triads, CAGED, harmony, and sixteenth-note comping.

SAFETY Stop for hand pain, numbness, or persistent wrist tension. Chord pressure should be minimal, not maximal.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

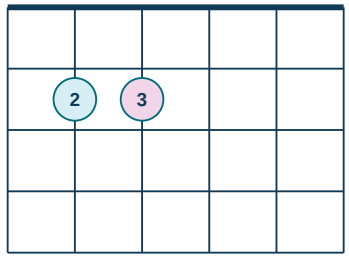
Chord-diagram legend, posture, and attack mechanics

LOW E LEFT | HIGH e RIGHT | X = MUTE | O = OPEN

READ THE SHAPE BEFORE APPLYING PRESSURE

Em - diagram example

O O O O



E B E G B E

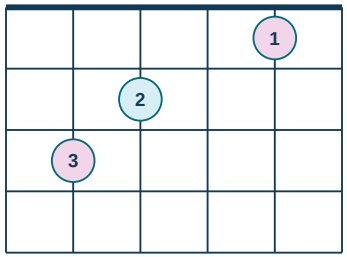
SPELL E A D G B e

ATTACK all 6 strings

FRETS 0 2 2 0 0 0

C - muted-bass example

X O



X C E G C E

SPELL A C E G

ATTACK A string through high e

FRETS x 3 2 0 1 0

Diagram legend

X	string must remain silent
O	open string rings
1-4	fretting-hand finger number
pink dot	root note
blue dot	non-root chord tone
thick line	nut; open-position reference

Fretting-hand setup

- [ ] Place fingertips just behind the fret wire, not on top of it.
- [ ] Keep the thumb relaxed behind the neck; do not clamp the palm to the neck.
- [ ] Allow open strings enough space beneath curved fingers.
- [ ] Form the entire shape before adding unnecessary squeeze.

Picking-hand setup

- [ ] Begin on the printed bass string; do not sweep across muted lower strings.
- [ ] Use shallow pick depth and a relaxed wrist.
- [ ] Strum through the active string group, then stop the motion.
- [ ] For audits, pick one string at a time with equal volume.

A chord diagram shows where to place the fingers. The exercise is not complete until the correct strings ring, the excluded strings remain silent, and the chord can release without the hand leaving the fretboard.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module A1 - minimum fretting pressure and clean release

6 NOTES x 4 ATTACKS = 24

FRET NEAR THE WIRE; FIND THE BUZZ THRESHOLD; ADD ONLY THE PRESSURE REQUIRED

Use the six printed notes to calibrate pressure with each finger. Attack 1 uses normal pressure. Attack 2 gradually reduces pressure until a buzz appears. Attack 3 adds the smallest amount needed for a clean tone. Attack 4 releases pressure without lifting the finger off the string.

Index finger - G1 (G#)

```
Atk|1----2----3----4----|
  G|1----1----1----1----|
Job|clean|fade |clean|mute |
```

The finger remains in contact after attack 4; the pitch stops because pressure releases.

Middle finger - A2 (B)

```
Atk|1----2----3----4----|
  A|2----2----2----2----|
Job|clean|fade |clean|mute |
```

The finger remains in contact after attack 4; the pitch stops because pressure releases.

Ring finger - D2 (E)

```
Atk|1----2----3----4----|
  D|2----2----2----2----|
Job|clean|fade |clean|mute |
```

The finger remains in contact after attack 4; the pitch stops because pressure releases.

Index finger - B1 (C)

```
Atk|1----2----3----4----|
  B|1----1----1----1----|
Job|clean|fade |clean|mute |
```

The finger remains in contact after attack 4; the pitch stops because pressure releases.

Middle finger - e2 (F#)

```
Atk|1----2----3----4----|
  e|2----2----2----2----|
Job|clean|fade |clean|mute |
```

The finger remains in contact after attack 4; the pitch stops because pressure releases.

Ring finger - B3 (D)

```
Atk|1----2----3----4----|
  B|3----3----3----3----|
Job|clean|fade |clean|mute |
```

The finger remains in contact after attack 4; the pitch stops because pressure releases.

Pressure audit

A deep fingertip groove, white knuckles, or a bent wrist indicates excess force. A buzz that disappears only when the hand squeezes harder usually means the finger is too far from the fret or touching a neighboring string.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module A2 - unused-string muting and six-string audit

8 CHORDS x 6 STRINGS = 48

PICK EVERY STRING; X STRINGS MUST PRODUCE NO PITCH

Form the chord, then pick low E through high e one string at a time. A muted string may create a dry click but no note. Do not skip the X strings during the audit; deliberately test them.

Chord	E	A	D	G	B	e	Right-hand start	Muting responsibility
Em	0	2	2	0	0	0	all 6 strings	all strings active; prevent accidental string contact
E	0	2	2	1	0	0	all 6 strings	all strings active; prevent accidental string contact
Am	X	0	2	2	1	0	A string through high e	low E: fretting-hand touch + accurate start
A	X	0	2	2	2	0	A string through high e	low E: fretting-hand touch + accurate start
Dm	X	X	0	2	3	1	D string through high e	low E/A: accurate D-string start; optional relaxed touch
D	X	X	0	2	3	2	D string through high e	low E/A: accurate D-string start; optional relaxed touch
C	X	3	2	0	1	0	A string through high e	low E: fretting-hand touch + accurate start
							all 6	

Left-hand muting methods

Use fingertip curvature to avoid touching higher strings. Use the underside of a fretting finger to stop an adjacent unused string when natural. A relaxed thumb may touch low E only if the wrist remains neutral.

Right-hand attack-zone methods

Aim the first stroke at the chord bass string. Stop the strum after the highest active string. Accuracy is preferred over a wide motion that relies on left-hand muting to hide every mistake.

PASS Complete the full table with downstrokes, then repeat the audit with light upstrokes from high e to low E.

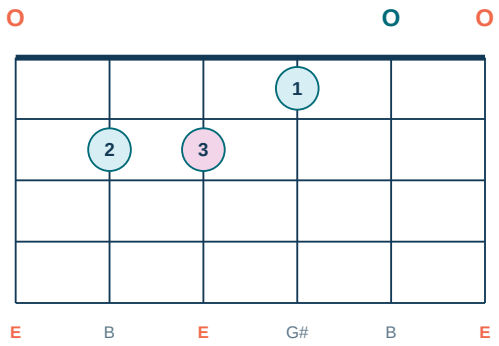
Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module B - E / Em family

2 CHORDS | 24 ATTACKS

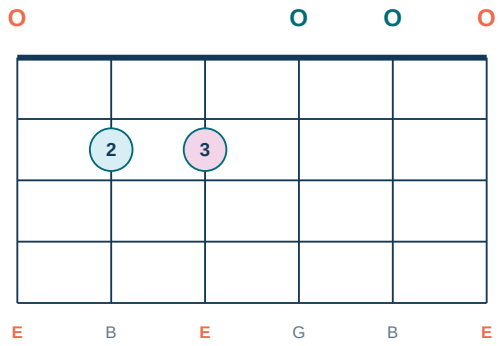
BUILD, AUDIT, RELEASE, AND RE-GRIP BEFORE CHANGING TEMPO

E



SPELL	E B E G# B E
ATTACK	all 6 strings
FRETS	0 2 2 1 0 0

Em



SPELL	E B E G B E
ATTACK	all 6 strings
FRETS	0 2 2 0 0 0

Family mechanics

RULE	Add or lift one finger; fingers 2-3 remain planted.
BUILD A	A2 -> D2 -> G1
BUILD B	A2 -> D2

Keep fingers 2-3 planted when alternating with Em.

Use fingers 2-3 so E major is created by adding finger 1.

E clean cell

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|0----2----2----1----0----0----|
Fng|O----2----3----1----O----O----|
Nte|E----B----E----G#---B----E----|



Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----D----|
```

Em clean cell

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|0----2----2----0----0----0----|
Fng|O----2----3----O----O----O----|
Nte|E----B----E----G----B----E----|



Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----D----|
```

CHANGE	After both 12-attack cells are clean, alternate E and Em once per four beats without changing the attack zone.

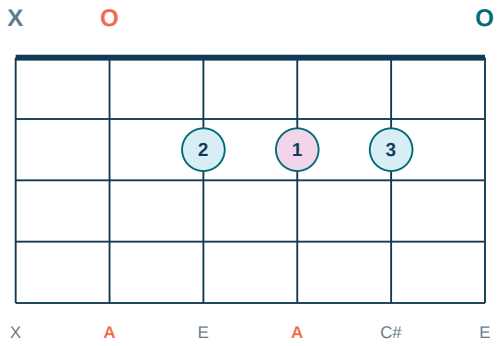
Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module B - A / Am family

2 CHORDS | 24 ATTACKS

BUILD, AUDIT, RELEASE, AND RE-GRIP BEFORE CHANGING TEMPO

A

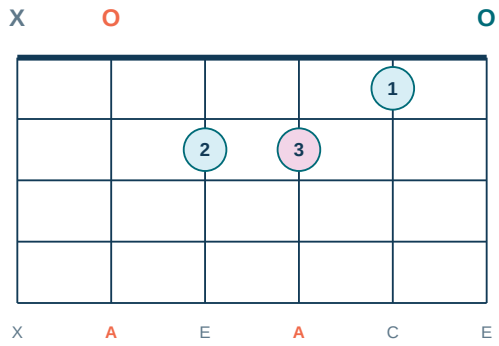


SPELL A C# E

ATTACK A string through high e

FRETS x 0 2 2 2 0

Am



SPELL A C E

ATTACK A string through high e

FRETS x 0 2 2 1 0

Family mechanics

RULE Keep the hand compact and land from the A string.

BUILD A G2 -> D2 -> B2

BUILD B D2 -> G2 -> B1

Printed transition fingering 2-1-3 keeps finger 1 available as the A-to-D pivot.

Use the underside of finger 2 or the thumb edge to silence low E without squeezing.

A clean cell

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|X----0----2----2----2----0----|
Fng|X----O----2----1----3----O----|
Nte|X----A----E----A----C#---E----|


Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----D----|
```

Am clean cell

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|X----0----2----2----1----0----|
Fng|X----O----2----3----1----O----|
Nte|X----A----E----A----C----E----|


Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----D----|
```

CHANGE After both 12-attack cells are clean, alternate A and Am once per four beats without changing the attack zone.

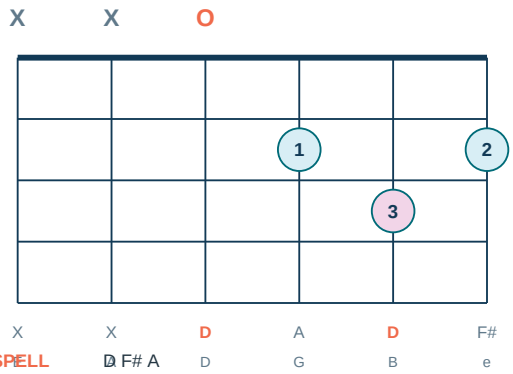
Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module B - D / Dm family

2 CHORDS | 24 ATTACKS

BUILD, AUDIT, RELEASE, AND RE-GRIP BEFORE CHANGING TEMPO

D

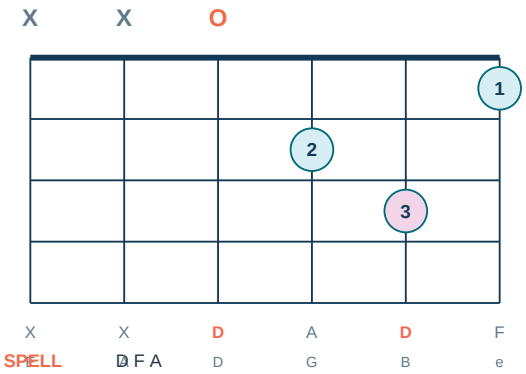


SPELL D F# A

ATTACK D string through high e

FRETS x x 0 2 3 2

Dm



SPELL D F A

ATTACK D string through high e

FRETS x x 0 2 3 1

Family mechanics

RULE Finger 3 on B3 is the pivot; begin every strum on D.

BUILD A G2 -> e2 -> B3

BUILD B e1 -> G2 -> B3

Begin the strum on the D string; low E and A stay silent.

Finger 3 on B3 remains the pivot when moving to D major.

D clean cell

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|X----X----0----2----3----2----|
Fng|X----X----O----1----3----2----|
Nte|X----X----D----A----D----F#---|



Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----D----|
```

Dm clean cell

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|X----X----0----2----3----1----|
Fng|X----X----O----2----3----1----|
Nte|X----X----D----A----D----F----|



Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----D----|
```

CHANGE After both 12-attack cells are clean, alternate D and Dm once per four beats without changing the attack zone.

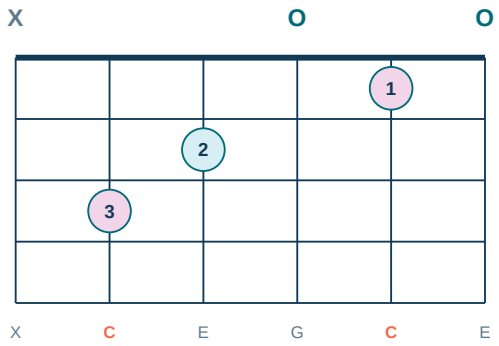
Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module B - C and G major

2 CHORDS | 24 ATTACKS

BUILD, AUDIT, RELEASE, AND RE-GRIP BEFORE CHANGING TEMPO

C

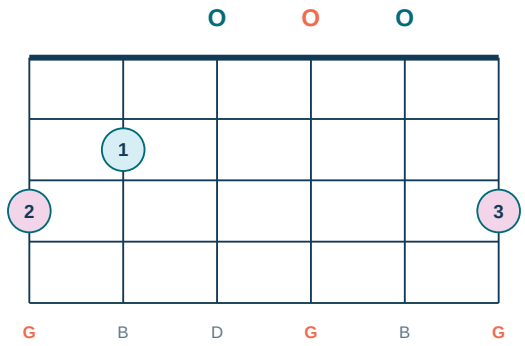


SPELL C E G

ATTACK A string through high e

FRETS x 3 2 0 1 0

G



SPELL G B D

ATTACK all 6 strings

FRETS 3 2 0 0 0 3

Family mechanics

RULE Two essential open major shapes; use guide-finger movement, not a flyi

BUILD A A3 -> D2 -> B1

BUILD B A2 -> low E3 -> high e3

A3 is the guide destination from G; B1 and D2 remain planted when moving to Am.

Keep the index on A2 available as the common finger for G-to-Em.

C clean cell

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|X----3----2----0----1----0----|
Fng|X----3----2----O----1----O----|
Nte|X----C----E----G----C----E----|



Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----D----|
```

G clean cell

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|3----2----0----0----0----3----|
Fng|2----1----O----O----O----3----|
Nte|G----B----D----G----B----G----|



Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----D----|
```

CHANGE After both 12-attack cells are clean, alternate C and G once per four beats without changing the attack zone.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

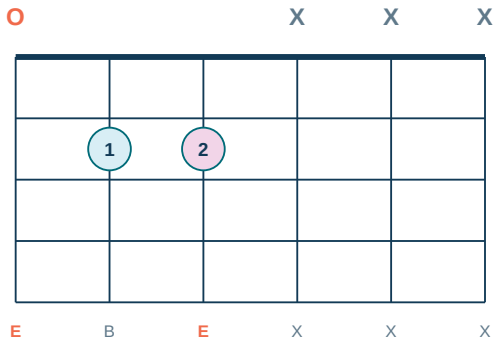
Module C - open power chords and pressure-release pulses

E5 / A5 / D5 | 36 ATTACKS

ROOT + FIFTH + OCTAVE; ALL OTHER STRINGS REMAIN SILENT

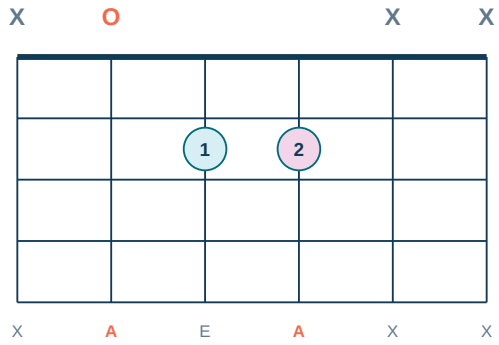
Power chords remove the third, so they sound neither major nor minor. The muting challenge is stricter than the fingering challenge: only three adjacent strings should speak.

E5



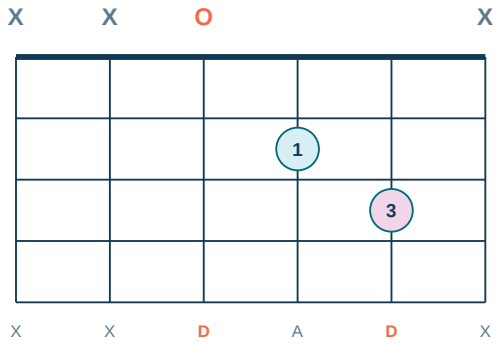
SPELL	E B E
ATTACK	low E through D
FRETS	0 2 2 x x x

A5



SPELL	A E A
ATTACK	A through G
FRETS	x 0 2 2 x x

D5



SPELL	D A D
ATTACK	D through B
FRETS	x x 0 2 3 x

E5 - 12 attacks

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|0----2----2----X----X----X----|
Fng|O----1----2----X----X----X----|
Nte|E----B----E----X----X----X----|


Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----x----|
```

A5 - 12 attacks

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|X----0----2----2----X----X----|
Fng|X----O----1----2----X----X----|
Nte|X----A----E----A----X----X----|


Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----x----|
```

D5 - 12 attacks

```
Str|E----A----D----G----B----e----|
Val|X----X----0----2----3----X----|
Fng|X----X----O----1----3----X----|
Nte|X----X----D----A----D----X----|


Atk|D----x----D----x----6----5----4----3----2----1----D----x----|
```

PULSE Strum, release pressure without lifting, strum the muted strings, then reapply pressure. The hand stays in place.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module D - whole-note chord changes

8 PAIRS x 8 ATTACKS = 64

ONE CHORD PER BAR; USE THE ENTIRE FOUR-BEAT SUSTAIN TO PREPARE THE NEXT SHAPE

Tempo 40-60 BPM. Attack on beat 1, sustain through beat 4, release, and land the next chord exactly on the following beat 1. Do not strum early to hide an incomplete shape.

E <-> Em

add/lift finger 1

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|E----Em---E----Em---E----Em---E----Em---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

A <-> Am

compact three-finger exchange

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|A----Am---A----Am---A----Am---A----Am---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

D <-> Dm

finger 3 remains on B3

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|D----Dm---D----Dm---D----Dm---D----Dm---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

C <-> Am

B1 and D2 remain planted

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|C----Am---C----Am---C----Am---C----Am---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

Em <-> G

alternate Em fingering keeps A2 planted

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|Em---G----Em---G----Em---G----Em---G----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

G <-> C

finger 2/3 guide from low E3 to A3

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|G----C----G----C----G----C----G----C----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

D <-> A

finger 1 remains on G2 with printed A fingering

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|D----A----D----A----D----A----D----A----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

E <-> A

move as one relaxed shape; land from bass side

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|E----A----E----A----E----A----E----A----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module E - half-note chord changes

8 PAIRS x 8 ATTACKS = 64

TWO ATTACKS PER BAR; CHANGE ON THE NEXT BARLINE

Tempo 40-60 BPM. Strum on beats 1 and 3. During beat 4, reduce pressure, prepare the next shape, and land on the next beat 1. Both attacks inside the bar must sound equally clean.

E <-> Em

add/lift finger 1

```
Cnt|1----3----1----3----1----3----1----3----|
Chd|E----E----Em---Em---E----E----Em---Em---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

A <-> Am

compact three-finger exchange

```
Cnt|1----3----1----3----1----3----1----3----|
Chd|A----A----Am---Am---A----A----Am---Am---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

D <-> Dm

finger 3 remains on B3

```
Cnt|1----3----1----3----1----3----1----3----|
Chd|D----D----Dm---Dm---D----D----Dm---Dm---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

C <-> Am

B1 and D2 remain planted

```
Cnt|1----3----1----3----1----3----1----3----|
Chd|C----C----Am---Am---C----C----Am---Am---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

Em <-> G

alternate Em fingering keeps A2 planted

```
Cnt|1----3----1----3----1----3----1----3----|
Chd|Em---Em---G----G----Em---Em---G----G----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

G <-> C

finger 2/3 guide from low E3 to A3

```
Cnt|1----3----1----3----1----3----1----3----|
Chd|G----G----C----C----G----G----C----C----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

D <-> A

finger 1 remains on G2 with printed A fingering

```
Cnt|1----3----1----3----1----3----1----3----|
Chd|D----D----A----A----D----D----A----A----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

E <-> A

move as one relaxed shape; land from bass side

```
Cnt|1----3----1----3----1----3----1----3----|
Chd|E----E----A----A----E----E----A----A----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module F - quarter-note chord changes

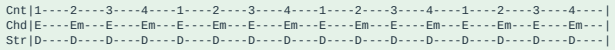
8 PAIRS x 16 ATTACKS = 128

CHANGE ON EVERY BEAT; SOUND QUALITY STILL OUTRANKS SPEED

Begin at 35-50 BPM. Alternate the two chords on beats 1, 2, 3, and 4 for four bars. Stop after the first buzz, muted chord tone, wrong bass string, or late landing.

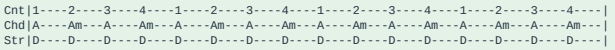
E <-> Em

add/lift finger 1



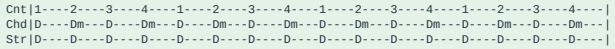
A <-> Am

compact three-finger exchange



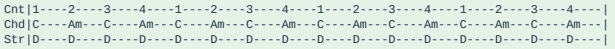
D <-> Dm

finger 3 remains on B3



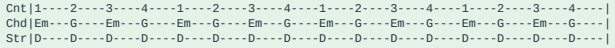
C <-> Am

B1 and D2 remain planted



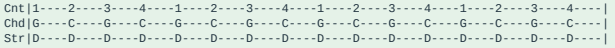
Em <-> G

alternate Em fingering keeps A2 planted



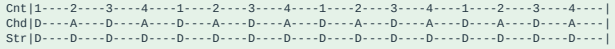
G <-> C

finger 2/3 guide from low E3 to A3



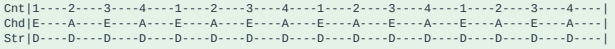
D <-> A

finger 1 remains on G2 with printed A fingering



E <-> A

move as one relaxed shape; land from bass side



Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module G - chord-change economy: common, pivot, and guide fingers

CELLS 1-4 | 32 ATTACKS

MOVE ONLY THE FINGERS THAT MUST MOVE

Each cell uses eight whole-note attacks. Before the first strum, name the stationary finger, guide finger, or shape change. After every attack, freeze the hand and inspect whether unnecessary fingers lifted.

E <-> Em

Keep fingers 2-3 on A2/D2. Add or lift finger 1 at G1.

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|E----Em---E----Em---E----Em---E----Em---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

FREEZE After each attack, check that the printed common or guide finger stayed close.

D <-> Dm

Keep finger 3 on B3. Exchange G2/e2 for G2/e1 without collapsing the knuckles.

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|D----Dm---D----Dm---D----Dm---D----Dm---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

FREEZE After each attack, check that the printed common or guide finger stayed close.

C <-> Am

Keep finger 1 on B1 and finger 2 on D2. Move finger 3 from A3 to G2.

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|C----Am---C----Am---C----Am---C----Am---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

FREEZE After each attack, check that the printed common or guide finger stayed close.

G <-> Em

Use alternate Em fingering 1 on A2 and 2 on D2. Finger 1 stays on A2.

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|G----Em---G----Em---G----Em---G----Em---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

FREEZE After each attack, check that the printed common or guide finger stayed close.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module G - chord-change economy: common, pivot, and guide fingers

CELLS 5-8 | 32 ATTACKS

MOVE ONLY THE FINGERS THAT MUST MOVE

Each cell uses eight whole-note attacks. Before the first strum, name the stationary finger, guide finger, or shape change. After every attack, freeze the hand and inspect whether unnecessary fingers lifted.

Em <-> C

Keep finger 2 on D2. Add B1 and A3 while releasing A2.

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|Em---C----Em---C----Em---C----Em---C----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

FREEZE After each attack, check that the printed common or guide finger stayed close.

G <-> C

Use the low-E3 finger as a guide to A3; release before crossing strings.

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|G----C----G----C----G----C----G----C----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

FREEZE After each attack, check that the printed common or guide finger stayed close.

A <-> D

Use A fingering 2-1-3. Finger 1 remains on G2; fingers 2 and 3 move.

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|A----D----A----D----A----D----A----D----|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

FREEZE After each attack, check that the printed common or guide finger stayed close.

A <-> Am

Keep the hand compact. Change the third from C# at B2 to C at B1 without dragging.

```
Cnt|1----2----3----4----5----6----7----8----|
Chd|A----Am---A----Am---A----Am---A----Am---|
Str|D----D----D----D----D----D----D----D----|
```

FREEZE After each attack, check that the printed common or guide finger stayed close.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module H - six-string arpeggiated clean checks

8 CHORDS x 12 STRING ATTACKS = 96

PICK LOW TO HIGH, THEN HIGH TO LOW; X STRINGS ARE TESTED, NOT SKIPPED

The audit sequence is 6-5-4-3-2-1 | 1-2-3-4-5-6. If a muted string sounds a pitch, repair the muting. If an active string is dead, inspect finger angle and fret placement before adding pressure.

Chord	6	5	4	3	2	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	Primary failure to check
Em	0	2	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	2	0	G/B strings muted by flat fingers
E	0	2	2	1	0	0	0	0	1	2	2	0	G/B strings muted by flat fingers
Am	X	0	2	2	1	0	0	1	2	2	0	X	low E leaks or open high strings are touched
A	X	0	2	2	2	0	0	2	2	2	0	X	low E leaks or open high strings are touched
Dm	X	X	0	2	3	1	1	3	2	0	X	X	A string rings or finger 1 collapses
D	X	X	0	2	3	2	2	3	2	0	X	X	A string rings or finger 1 collapses
C	X	3	2	0	1	0	0	1	0	2	3	X	low E leaks or open high strings are touched
G	3	2	0	0	0	3	3	0	0	0	2	3	open D/G/B strings touched by fretting fingers

REPAIR Isolate the failing string, correct the hand, then restart the complete 12-string audit. Do not resume halfway through.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module I - open major-chord progressions

3 PROGRESSIONS x 16 ATTACKS = 48

FOUR BARS; FOUR DOWNSTROKES PER BAR

Play one chord per bar with quarter-note downstrokes. Sustain each attack without releasing early. Speak the Roman-numeral function before each bar-one.

A-D-E-A

FUNCTION I-IV-V-I in A

```
Cnt|1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---|
Chd|A---A---A---A---D---D---D---E---E---E---E---A---A---A---A---A---|
Str|D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---|
```

AUDIT Correct bass string, all chord tones clean, no release before the next beat.

D-G-A-D

FUNCTION I-IV-V-I in D

```
Cnt|1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---|
Chd|D---D---D---D---G---G---G---G---A---A---A---A---D---D---D---D---|
Str|D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---|
```

AUDIT Correct bass string, all chord tones clean, no release before the next beat.

G-C-D-G

FUNCTION I-IV-V-I in G

```
Cnt|1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---|
Chd|G---G---G---G---C---C---C---C---D---D---D---D---G---G---G---G---|
Str|D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---|
```

AUDIT Correct bass string, all chord tones clean, no release before the next beat.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module I - open minor and relative-key progressions

3 PROGRESSIONS x 16 ATTACKS = 48

KEEP THE MINOR CHORD QUALITY CLEAR; DO NOT LET OPEN STRINGS BLUR THE CHANGE

Use the same quarter-note protocol. Listen specifically for the major third versus minor third in each chord family. The progression is not complete if the shapes change but the chord quality is unclear.

Em-G-D-C

FUNCTION i-III-VII-VI in E minor

```
Cnt|1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---|
Chd|Em--Em--Em--Em--G---G---G---G---D---D---D---D---C---C---C---C---|
Str|D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---|
```

AUDIT Name the quality: major or minor. Preserve the correct attack zone through every change.

Am-C-G-Em

FUNCTION i-III-VII-v in A minor

```
Cnt|1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---|
Chd|Am--Am--Am--Am--C---C---C---C---G---G---G---G---Em--Em--Em--Em--|
Str|D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---|
```

AUDIT Name the quality: major or minor. Preserve the correct attack zone through every change.

Am-Dm-Em-Am

FUNCTION i-iv-v-i in A minor

```
Cnt|1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---1---2---3---4---|
Chd|Am--Am--Am--Am--Dm--Dm--Dm--Dm--Em--Em--Em--Em--Am--Am--Am--Am--|
Str|D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---D---|
```

AUDIT Name the quality: major or minor. Preserve the correct attack zone through every change.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Module J - four-pass rhythm and release capstone

Am-C-G-Em | 64 ATTACKS

SAME FOUR CHORDS; FOUR DIFFERENT RIGHT-HAND AND RELEASE BEHAVIORS

Complete all four passes without stopping. The chord order remains Am-C-G-Em. Reset the tempo only between complete passes, never inside the progression.

Pass 1 - sustained quarters

Four downstrokes per bar; allow every chord to ring.

```
Grid|D D D D|
Bars|Am | C | G | Em |
Count|16 attacks|
```

RULE The final attack of each bar must not delay the next chord formation.

Pass 2 - release after each attack

Strum, release pressure halfway through the beat, reapply before the next attack.

```
Grid|D . D . D . D .|
Bars|Am | C | G | Em |
Count|16 attacks|
```

RULE The final attack of each bar must not delay the next chord formation.

Pass 3 - chord plus muted backbeat

Pitched chord on beats 1 and 3; muted strum on beats 2 and 4.

```
Grid|D x D x|
Bars|Am | C | G | Em |
Count|16 attacks|
```

RULE The final attack of each bar must not delay the next chord formation.

Pass 4 - four-string arpeggio

Pick four active chord strings in a stable repeating order.

```
Grid|1 2 3 4|
Bars|Am | C | G | Em |
Count|16 attacks|
```

RULE The final attack of each bar must not delay the next chord formation.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Practice progression, one-minute change tests, and error diagnosis

CLEAN CHANGES BEFORE FASTER STRUMMING

MEASURE BOTH SPEED AND QUALITY; A BUZZY REP DOES NOT COUNT

Ten-phase practice progression

- [ ] 1. Diagram legend and posture
- [ ] 2. Pressure calibration
- [ ] 3. Muting audit
- [ ] 4. E/Em and A/Am
- [ ] 5. D/Dm and C/G
- [ ] 6. Power chords
- [ ] 7. Whole-note changes
- [ ] 8. Half-note changes
- [ ] 9. Quarter-note changes
- [ ] 10. Progression capstone

Error diagnosis

BUZZ
move closer to fret before adding pressure

DEAD OPEN STRING
increase finger curvature

WRONG BASS
aim the first stroke at the printed string

X STRING RINGS
add relaxed touch or narrow the strum

LATE CHORD
prepare during the prior sustain

FINGERS FLY
freeze and move one finger at a time

EARLY RELEASE
hold through the full count

PAIN/TENSION
stop, shake out, reduce duration and pressure

One-minute change tests

Choose four pairs. Count only transitions in which both chords are fully formed, the correct bass string is struck, and no required chord tone is muted. Use whole-note changes first; quarter-note testing begins only after a clean 20-change whole-note minute.

Pair	Whole-note clean changes	Quarter-note clean changes	Primary mechanic
E-Em			add/lift finger 1
A-Am			compact three-finger exchange
D-Dm			finger 3 remains on B3
C-Am			B1 and D2 remain planted
Em-G			alternate Em fingering keeps A2 planted
G-C			finger 2/3 guide from low E3 to A3
D-A			finger 1 remains on G2 with printed A fingering
E-A			move as one relaxed shape; land from bass side

ADVANCE Add 2 BPM after three clean loops. After two failures, reduce 4-6 BPM or return to the slower rhythmic division.

DAILY LIMIT Stop chord repetitions before fatigue changes hand position. Quality falls before pain begins.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 49

Mastery gate, completion audit, and transition to Level 50

SECTION VI FOUNDATION CHECK

THE PLAYER MUST FORM, MUTE, RELEASE, AND CHANGE THE CHORDS WITHOUT LOSING THE BEAT

Mastery gate before Level 50

- [ ] Name notes and quality of Em, E, Am, A, Dm, D, C, and G.
- [ ] Form all eight shapes without watching the entire setup.
- [ ] Complete every six-string muting audit correctly.
- [ ] Play eight chord cells and three power-chord cells cleanly.
- [ ] Complete whole-, half-, and quarter-note grids on time.
- [ ] Demonstrate all eight common/pivot/guide transitions.
- [ ] Play three major and three minor progressions from memory.
- [ ] Complete the Am-C-G-Em capstone on two separate days.

Completion audit and practice log

- [ ] Pressure lab
- [ ] Muting audit
- [ ] 8 chord cells
- [ ] 3 power chords
- [ ] whole changes
- [ ] half changes
- [ ] quarter changes
- [ ] 8 transition cells
- [ ] 6 progressions
- [ ] capstone

Date	Focus / pair	Division	BPM	Clean?	Weak string / finger	Next target

Next: Level 50 - chord transitions and common-finger movement

Level 50 will keep these open shapes but move the changes into smaller rhythmic windows, add anticipation and release timing, develop common-finger and guide-finger transition families, and create longer progression studies without allowing chord quality or muting to deteriorate.